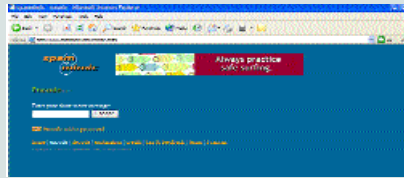


Hiding your Secret Message

There are various software tools available that encrypt messages for increased security. However, it is still evident that the particular message has been encrypted and an interceptor may attempt to decipher it.

Spammimic.com offers an alternative to hide your message inside what would appear to be a harmless spam.



Encoding your message at Spammimic.com

Just point your browser to the Web site, and click on the 'encode' link. Type the message in the text box provided. Next, click on the Encode button. You will now be shown a long message that will appear like a regular spam message to anybody who sees it. What the intended recipient of your message needs to do is to go to spammimic.com, click on the 'decode' link, paste the message into the text box, and click on the Decode button. Voila! The original message appears. You also have the option of adding a password while encoding a message. The recipient will have to enter the same password to decode, and view the message.

and is owned by them. In both cases, your address is recorded and valued more highly because you have just identified it as being read by a human.

It helps to check a Web site's privacy policy before subscribing to newsletters: Keep in mind that there is a difference between subscribing to receive mail for a specific purpose and junk mail. If you don't agree with a Web site's privacy policy, don't subscribe for e-mail updates. Remember not all the mail that comes into your box is necessarily spam.

A workaround is to use two e-mail accounts—one for official and personal correspondence, and the other to be used while surfing. This way, you can enlist the other ID for newsletters, and registrations, channeling potential spam to it.

Physical spam

Besides the digital spam we are all familiar with, there exists another form of spam—physical spam. This involves sending printed brochures and catalogues to a list of recipients, through Web sites offering these for free. The recipient has to cull through reams of unrequested fliers, brochures, catalogues and other marketing material to filter the required e-mail. This can also take anti-racial, or anti-religious forms wherein brochures or catalogues that may be objectionable to certain communities, or religions are targeted at specific groups of people. Another variation of physical spam aims to paralyse the normal working of the postal system by targeting a specific geographical area. This causes the post office handling e-mails for that region to be blocked by hundreds of catalogues or mailers.

It is indeed irritating to see spam when checking your e-mail. It's something you'd gladly love to click goodbye forever. Well, that is possible to a certain extent. Spam can be countered successfully only through a combined effort of all Netizens. Every possible instance has to be reported and dealt with. This will ensure that the culprits get detected and pay the price for their uninvited, havoc-wreaking e-mails. 

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